



PURPOSE:

High-quality social studies assessments focus on the evaluation of evidence, social studies content knowledge, and disciplinary argumentation. The rubric is intended to support local education agencies (LEAs) in monitoring student progress and growth across a social studies curriculum, aligned to DC social studies standards.

The non-evaluative rubric is intended to evaluate a summative assessment program and can be utilized to facilitate conversations about high-quality formative assessments within a curriculum. The rubric is intended to be used to assess a range of assessment practices including summative student discourse, writing, and project-based tasks.

The rubric does not provide guidance about the use of assessments, in which students have previous experience with the assessment material or assessments in which students are reviewing an assessment prompt for the first time.¹ Both forms of assessment are valid measures for collecting data about students' application of social studies content and skills, and a strong assessment program utilizes both forms of assessment.

DIRECTIONS:

Users should use the rubric below to evaluate proposed assessment tasks. Following the initial evaluation of assessment tasks, reviewers should determine if the assessment:

- Meets expectations - All the indicators below are met by the assessment task.
- Partially meets expectations - Most of the indicators are met by the assessment task.
- Does not meet expectations - Less than 50 percent of the indicators are met by the assessment task.

If the assessment does not meet expectations, the LEA or educator should identify an alternate assessment type that is aligned to the expectations set forth by the social studies standards. If the assessment partially meets expectations, the reviewer should consider what changes need to be made to ensure the assessment represents a high-quality evaluation of student progress in social studies.

1 Definitions:

- Warm assessment: In a warm assessment, students know the assessment prompt ahead of time and have seen any documents or content prior to answering an assessment question. For example, students know at the start of a unit they will be assessed on the question "Was Lincoln a good leader during the Civil War" and spend a full unit evaluating evidence in response to this question. A warm assessment allows students to use documents or information they have evaluated in class to respond to this prompt.
- Cold assessment: In a cold assessment, students have not seen the assessment prompt or material ahead of the assessment. This kind of assessment is best for assessing student mastery of specific social studies skills. For example, students may be given a copy of a painting of the First Thanksgiving they have not previously analyzed and asked to evaluate its utility for understanding the relationship between Puritans and the Wampanoag.

Criterion for Success	Indicators	Next Steps
Standards Alignment	Assessment is clearly aligned to both the content and disciplinary skills outlined by the grade level standards in the OSSE Social Studies Standards.	
Assessment Task	- Assessment task(s) requires students to answer cognitively rigorous prompts that have several valid legitimate civic, historical, economic or geographic interpretations. - The assessment questions necessitate evaluative rather than factual responses. - The questions are grade level accessible, narrow in scope, and answerable using the materials and evidence provided. Students must evaluate evidence, utilize historical, civic, or geographic knowledge and engage in social studies analysis in response to the assessment task.	
Evaluation of Evidence	- Students demonstrate the ability to assess the utility and limitations of primary and/or secondary texts through historical thinking skills such as sourcing, corroboration, close reading, and/or contextualization of evidence. - Students analyze the circumstances in which information was created and use that analysis to support claims. Source analysis moves beyond text comprehension and summarizing informational texts into evaluation and analysis of information utility.	
Social Studies Content Knowledge	- Assessment task(s) requires students to leverage social studies content knowledge to complete the assessment, and students are scored on content accuracy. - Content knowledge is utilized in service of demonstrating the skills of disciplinary thinking, reading, and reasoning.	
Claim Development	- Questions direct students to the historical, civic, or geographic record and utilize evidence and analysis to construct a claim. - Students build claims using evidence, content knowledge, and source analysis to support their conclusions.	
Transparency of expectations	- The assessment has clear criteria for student success. - Scoring rubrics are transparent and educators have developed norms for student responses.	
Representation and Historical Agency	- Students have opportunities to question historical narratives and build their own interpretations of the past and present grounded in valid critical analysis of available information. - Materials present historical actors with agency and dignity. - Assessment does not promote harmful stereotypes or engage students in harmful learning experiences. - Assessment utilizes precise and accurate terminology to describe the past.² - Lesson questions do not provide space for students to justify historical atrocities. - Assessments do not include role-play or have prompts that require students to take on personas from the past or present.	

2 Historically Accurate Terminology

- The following terminology list from the Great Lakes Center for Equity [Assessing Bias in Standards and Curricular Materials](#) is not an exhaustive list of appropriate historical terminology, however it may serve as bench mark for discussing this portion of the walkthrough tool.
 - Curricular materials avoid using language such as “roaming”, “wandering”, or “roving” to describe the travel of the Indigenous People of the United States.
 - The text avoids using language that suggests groups of people were order-less or uncivilized than Euro-Americans.
 - The text avoids using language that suggests specific groups of people needing “saving” or “help.”
 - Standards describes groups of people in such a way as to counter stereotypes, bias, and marginalization.

Criterion for Success	Indicators	Next Steps
Assessments are Scaffolded for Student Success	Source material is appropriately differentiated and modified for student needs. (Note: Sources may need to be modified and excerpted.)	
Feedback	- Students are provided with feedback on their knowledge of course content and mastery of social studies skills, such as sourcing, contextualization, corroboration, and close reading. - Feedback supports students in improving their analysis, disciplinary reasoning and argumentation skills.	

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